Supplemental Questionnaire

1. **Describe your knowledge, skills, and abilities in troubleshooting IT technical issues.**

In the 2.5 years I've actively been working in my Homelab environment, I've practiced resolving support issues in Active Directory related to user management. Common issues include user account creation and password resets. Within Active Directory, I created user accounts, configured password complexity policies, and assigned temporary passwords that required a change at first logon. This process was verified using a Windows 11 VM to join the domain and gain access to a fully functional virtual desktop.

Mapping network drives is also a common task that comes up frequently, which aligns with configurations I've already implemented on my own network. I configured an SMB fileshare on my Ubuntu server and mapped an external HD to it using the server's local IP address. I also mapped the same drive using the server's Tailscale IP which enables remote access for when I'm away from home. This setup provided some level of redundancy, as the drive remains accessible locally even if Tailscale service goes down.

In a later exercise, I implemented key-based SSH authentication between two Linux VMs. When the initial connection failed despite verified network connectivity, I suspected the issue was firewall related. After reviewing logs and creating a UFW rule to allow inbound SSH traffic, key-based authentication functioned as expected.

During my coursework at WGU, we were required to identify, troubleshoot, resolve, and document issues taken from real-world tickets in a simulated environment. There were seven tickets in total with varying degrees of difficulty, and the objective was to go through each ticket using standard processes found in live environments. These exercises were key in emphasizing the importance of proper documentation, so when similar or identical issues arise, the solutions have already been noted. While there was no ticketing software being used, the same steps from identifying the issue to the resolution were demonstrated.

2. **Describe a time when you made improvements to a business process.**

My 8 months of my experience at Block Advisors as a tax preparer for the season, I received calls and emails from clients requesting an update on the status of their return,

especially the ones that had large refunds. Most of those clients weren’t happy with the lack of communication. I made the mistake of thinking that once the appointment was over, and the return was filed, that was it. It didn’t take long for me to realize it was a critical mistake on my part and didn’t reflect well on Block Advisors. I thought to myself, “If I were the one expecting a large tax refund, I would appreciate it if I got a call from my preparer with an update." I started making sure to set a weekly reminder on my calendar to get in touch with every client I sat down with and give them an update on the status of their return. Even if it was only a several minute long phone call, they thanked me and appreciated the effort.

Once I made this change, clients started giving recommendations to their family and friends to come see me. My workload picked up during the middle and end of the tax season, which in turn increased the company's revenue. This made me realize that something as simple as a callback can have an extraordinary effect on how clients view our professional relationships. If I had simply remained content to ignore them, then that behavior would have reflected poorly on the company in the form of complaints or unsatisfactory client reviews, which ultimately would lead to a loss of potential revenue.